

The dawn of a new e-ra

The internet is inarguably mankind's greatest invention so far and it has helped us in more ways than you can imagine. This invention has to its credit the introduction of the biggest game changer in the world of education. We're, of course, talking about E-Learning.

Education has come a long way – from repeated oral recitations to stone inscriptions, to books. And now, education is on the verge of yet another breakthrough powerful enough to create a paradigm shift. With the world becoming more and more connected and computers becoming more easily available and a lot more cost effective, e-learning is truly coming of age and growing at an exponential rate.

With its humble beginnings as a bunch of interconnected computers on which students could watch recorded lectures, e-learning has seen it all – from correspondence courses to virtual classrooms. The 'E' in e-learning now stands for exciting, enlightening, easy and entertaining.

Elliot Masie, the gentleman who coined the term 'E-learning' once said "We need to bring learning to people instead of people to learning." With more and more individuals becoming a part of the World Wide Web and broadband speeds steadily rising, e-learning is affording individuals from a wide variety of backgrounds an opportunity to develop new skills and even earn degrees.

E-Learning, today, to a large extent is seen as a means to plug gaps inherent to the classroom system of learning, but seeing how the entire domain is growing by leaps and bounds, let's all be open to the fact that e-learning could be the alternative to classrooms.

Of course, e-learning still has its fair share of challenges to overcome. Its fatal flaw is in its medium. Today, e-learning is almost entirely internet based. Even the versions available offline require a working internet connection for updates and content.